

Banking Transaction Troubleshooting

Original Prompt

Act as banking transaction troubleshooting assistant.

Scenario: A customer tries to transfer █50,000. The transaction fails. Error shown was "Transaction could not be completed".

Analyze the scenario systematically.

Follow these steps:

1. Identify all possible failure categories.
2. For each possible cause, explain what system condition could cause it.
3. Identify the likely system or service that should be checked.
4. Recommend the next diagnostic action.
5. Do not assume a single root cause without evidence.
6. Return the result in a structured table.

Rule:

Think step by step

show your working

explain your reasoning before answering

Consider these possible causes:

- Daily limit exceeded
- Insufficient balance
- Bank server unavailable
- OTP expired
- Network timeout
- Beneficiary inactive
- Fraud rule triggered
- Core banking unavailable
- UPI switch unavailable

Assistant Answer

Below is a structured diagnostic approach. I'll avoid assuming a single root cause; the generic error “Transaction could not be completed” can map to several failures.

#	Possible failure cause	System condition that could cause it	System / service to check	Next diagnostic action
1	Daily limit exceeded	Customer has already transferred enough funds today that █50,000 exceeds the configured daily transaction limit.	Transaction-limit service / account profile / channel limits	Check cumulative daily transfer amount and applicable per-transaction/daily limits.
2	Insufficient balance	Available balance is below █50,000, or holds/lien amounts reduce the usable balance.	Core Banking System (CBS) / account-balance service	Query available balance; check holds, liens, and pending debits.
3	Bank server unavailable	Bank-side API/server is down, overloaded, unreachable, or returning errors.	Bank transaction APIs / integration layer / service monitoring	Check availability, error codes, latency, and server logs around the transaction timestamp.
4	OTP expired	OTP was not entered within its validity period, or the OTP session expired.	OTP / Authentication service	Check OTP generation, expiry time, verification attempt, and authentication response code.

#	Possible failure cause	System condition that could cause it	System / service to check	Next diagnostic action
5	Network timeout	A downstream service did not respond within the configured timeout.	API gateway / network layer / transaction orchestration	Trace the transaction using a correlation/reference ID and identify where it timed out.
6	Beneficiary inactive	Beneficiary is disabled, pending activation, blocked, deleted, or subject to a cooling-off period.	Beneficiary-management service / customer profile	Verify beneficiary status, activation timestamp, account details, and restrictions.
7	Fraud rule triggered	Transaction characteristics match a fraud/risk rule such as unusual amount, velocity, device, beneficiary, or pattern.	Fraud detection / risk engine	Check fraud/risk decision logs and whether the transaction was blocked, challenged, or held.
8	Core banking unavailable	CBS cannot process balance validation, debit, account validation, or posting because it is unavailable or degraded.	Core Banking System / CBS integration layer	Check CBS health, connectivity, transaction queues, and CBS response/error codes.
9	UPI switch unavailable	UPI routing/switch infrastructure is unavailable or cannot communicate with the required participant/bank.	UPI switch / payment gateway / bank UPI integration	Check switch health, connectivity, response codes, transaction status, and whether other UPI transactions are failing.

Diagnostic reasoning

The error message is non-specific, so the first step should be to obtain the transaction timestamp, transaction/reference ID, channel (UPI/NEFT/IMPS/etc.), customer/account identifier, and exact backend response code.

Diagnostic flow: Customer request → Authentication/OTP → Beneficiary validation → Limits & balance → Fraud/risk checks → Transaction orchestration → UPI/payment switch (if applicable) → Core Banking → Final transaction response

At each stage, determine whether the request reached the service, was accepted, was rejected and why, timed out, or was successfully processed but the response was lost.

Recommended first checks

Priority	Check	Why
1	Transaction/reference ID and timestamp	Allows end-to-end tracing
2	Backend error/response code	Converts the generic UI error into a specific failure
3	Transaction status in orchestration layer	Determines whether it failed, timed out, or is still pending
4	Available account balance	Rules out insufficient funds/holds
5	Applicable transaction limits	Rules out limit-based rejection
6	Beneficiary status	Rules out beneficiary restrictions
7	OTP/authentication logs	Rules out authentication expiry/failure
8	Fraud/risk decision	Determines whether the transaction was blocked
9	CBS and UPI-switch health/logs	Identifies infrastructure or downstream failures

Important: If the transaction was debited from the customer's account despite the failure message, do not immediately retry the ₹50,000 transfer. First reconcile the transaction status with the CBS/payment switch to prevent a duplicate transfer.